

Linux CLI Commands - Reference

Command	Definition
General Use Commands	
man <program name>	will show the manual or help file for that program
CTRL - C	gets you out of a running program in terminal
Q or q	exits out of a file that is being read
clear	brings you to an empty command prompt (clears screen)
 (aka pipe)	takes output from one command and sends to a 2nd command
Path Navigation	
pwd	display the path of the current directory
ls	list files and directories
ls -l	list all files in directory in LONG format = includes permissions, date and size
ls -a	list all files and directories including hidden ones
cd foldername	change to named directory
cd ..	change to parent directory (move up one level in directory)
cd ~	change to home directory
cd ~/folder	change to named folder in home-directory
File and Directory Management	
cp file1 file2	copy file1 and call it file2
mv file1 file2	move or rename file1 to file2
touch <name>	create an empty file
rm file	remove a file
cat file	display a file
less file	display a file a page at a time
file <filename>	find out what type of file it is - text, zip, jpg, etc.
mkdir	make a directory
rmdir directory	remove a directory
tree or ls -R	either command will show you the directory structure of folders and files for the whole drive
Advanced File Commands	
grep 'keyword' file	search a file for keywords
command > file	redirect standard output to a file
command >> file	append standard output to a file
sort	sort data in a file
*	wildcard - can be used to represent 'anything'

find <directory> <option> <item>	find a file by its name or by the username who owns it or by another type of selection. Example: <code>find /home/ubuntu -name secret.txt</code>
Administrative Commands	
whoami	identify the active user
su <username>	switch active user to another user
sudo su	switches over to the root account
sudo <command>	superuser! "run this command as administrator"
apt-get install <program>	install a program from the online repository in some types of Linux this is done through the YUM command
apt-get remove <program>	remove a program. To make sure all associated files are removed you should use the apt-get purge
history	show all commands types into terminal. Saves up to 1000 commands in most Linux versions
Networking commands	
ifconfig or ip a	display the ip address information for the local computer
ping	send packets to another device to test connectivity and latency <code>ping <destination IP address> -c <number of packets></code>
ssh (Secure Shell)	open a secure encrypted connection with another computer using the SSH protocol. Syntax: <code>ssh <username>@<ipaddress or domain> -p <port number></code> Ex: <code>ssh adminuser@192.168.1.2 -p 22</code>
nc (netcat)	open a port on a computer to listen for incoming connections or to connect to another listening device. Listening syntax: <code>nc -l <port number></code> Connecting syntax: <code>nc <destination IP address> -p <port number></code>
netstat	Monitor incoming and outgoing connections on a device <code>netstat -na</code> n = don't try to find hostnames for external IP addresses a = display all active TCP connections t = restrict display to only TCP sockets